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Response for Progressivism

This discussion will talk about how Theodore Roosevelt approached the problem of wealth inequality in the time of the American Industrial Revolution, using the texts of "Theodore Roosevelt on The New Nationalism" and "Woodrow Wilson on the New Freedom". To start off Roosevelt sees a disaster, despite the unprecedented growth of wealth during the revolution, the lives of the bottom wealth class had significantly worsened due to greedy giant corporations. Roosevelt came from a period of time where this problem came up for the first time in all of history. He had no past points of time or references of this problem ever occurring before. In addition he argues that the world has changed so much from before the revolution, that approaching the problem is complicated. Even simple governmental involvement could provoke a depression which has happened before. The Revolution made liberty so hard to define, does it include owning a home, having a big enough wage to live, or having the ability to make it big in the states and get rich. Liberty was the core principle of his actions. Roosevelt argued that government regulation is necessary to preserve liberty as without regulation workers would be completely hopeless against corporations, simply a living wage is essential to liberty. His trust destruction policy came from the idea that equal opportunity is necessary for liberty, he broke down walls that made it hard for new businesses to be built. In the end the industrial revolution dramatically changed the world and new policies and meanings of liberty had to be built to put checks and balances of the "machine" of the United States.